

A3. Visual project report

Start Assignment

- Due 22 Oct by 9:00
- Points 40
- Submitting a text entry box, a website url, or a file upload
- File types pdf
- Available after 21 Jul at 0:00

Visual Project Report Guidelines

As part of your Capstone project, you are required to submit a **Visual Project Report** that clearly communicates your entire design journey, combining **text, diagrams, graphics, and photographs**.

*There will be no evaluation on your Miro board, so you are expected to **curate and organise your process materials** from Miro and other sources into one cohesive and accessible printed report format.

Format and Structure

The format of your report is portrait or landscape A4, PDF.

You can design it the way you prefer, but it must be **well-organised, visually engaging**, and aligned with the **design methodology you have chosen** (e.g. *Discover, Define, Develop, Deliver*). We suggest you structure your content with clear **titles and subtitles** within these stages.

This is a **visual report**, so prioritise clarity and visual communication: use diagrams, graphs, sketches, and images wherever possible to summarise and support your ideas.

Core Questions to Address

Your report must comprehensively respond to the following:

-  **Why?**
- Why does this problem matter?
 - Why should we care?
 - Background and context of the chosen challenge
 - Brief summary of the original and refined *How Might We* (HMW) questions
 - Key research findings and insights that informed your design direction

-  **Who?**
- Who are you? Why did you choose this project?
 - How does this relate to your personal values and positionality?
 - Who are the stakeholders impacted by or benefiting from your project?
 - Who is your intended audience or user group?
(Support this section with persona tools or relevant demographic/secondary data)

-  **What?**
- What is your proposed solution?
 - What does it look like?
 - Show your **process** through: early sketches, photos of prototypes, diagrams, branding mock-ups, final renders or models

-  **How?**

- How does your proposal function?
- Are there steps, user interactions, or system flows?
- Include any relevant design documentation such as: system maps, storyboards, service blueprints, or technical diagrams

Impact

- What changes does your project propose?
- What are the key social, cultural, environmental, or economic impacts?
- Use any of the **impact frameworks** shared in class (e.g. *Theory of Change*) to communicate these clearly

Additional Report Requirements

Make sure your report includes:

- **Cover Page:** Project title, subtitle, your name, stream, year, Design Programme, and a small UoA logo
- **Project Summary (abstract):** A concise statement of the problem and the value your solution brings (120-300 words)
- **Contents Page or Index**
- **Reference to Brief:** Include a summary of the original brief, HMW question, and refined HMW question
- **Methodology and timeline:** Description of the Design methodology and timeline you followed
- **Research Findings:** Summarise with visual elements such as diagrams, graphs, and key quotes
- **Cultural Considerations and Positionality:** Reflect on your positionality, values, and engagement with Te Tiriti o Waitangi.
- **Process documentation:** early sketches, prototypes, etc.

Deliverables:

- Submit a digital file, **A4 PDF** (portrait or landscape, "optimised" PDF), around **50 pages (flexible - if needed)**
 - **Print and bind a physical book to exhibit alongside your prototype**
 - No strict word count, but ensure the content is **clear, concise, and focused**
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Academic Honesty declaration

This is a Lane 2 assignment completed under uncontrolled conditions.

You are allowed to use AI to assist in the development of your assessment. However, any use of such tools must be acknowledged appropriately. For guidance on referencing AI-generated content, visit [QuickCite](https://auckland.libguides.com/referencing-generative-ai-tools)  (<https://auckland.libguides.com/referencing-generative-ai-tools>).

By completing this assessment, I agree to the following declaration:

I understand the University expects all students to complete coursework with integrity and honesty. As a member of the University's student body, I will complete this assessment in a fair, honest, responsible and trustworthy manner.

This means that:

- *I declare this is my own work and have acknowledged all sources, including texts, images, datasets, templates, code and any AI or permitted third party contributions.*
- *I am aware the University of Auckland may use plagiarism detecting methods to check my submission.*
- *I declare that this work has not been submitted for academic credit in this course or another University of Auckland course, or elsewhere.*
- *I acknowledge that I have adhered to the assignment brief surrounding the use of permitted materials, software and third party assistance.*
- *I understand the University expects all students to complete coursework with integrity and honesty.*

Any breach of this statement or identified academic misconduct will be followed up and may result in disciplinary action.

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Criteria	Ratings				Pts
Design Process The submission demonstrates a clear, logical, and justified progression from brief to research-informed proposal, using appropriate Design Methodology and tools. - Stages of the chosen design methodology are clearly demonstrated, using appropriate design inquiry tools to gain insights leading to final outcomes.	10 to >8.0 Pts Excellent Excellent Implementation of taught methods and tools. Demonstration of coherence throughout the design process.	8 to >6.5 Pts Good to very good Generally good to strong understanding of methodology, tools, and coherence throughout the design process, with scope for improvement.	6.5 to >5.0 Pts Adequate Evidence of some understanding of the methodology and tools, but a moderate lack of coherence throughout the design process.	5 to >0 Pts Inadequate Methodology and tools were not adequately used, nor understood, evidenced by the lack of coherence throughout the design process.	10 pts
Criticality and relevance - Brief alignment: The submission shows evidence of investigations and critical thinking through commentary and insight regarding secondary research. -The report includes frequent reflective statements or commentary alongside work in progress.	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent Excellent understanding of subject matter, contextual issues and well synthesised arguments supporting the proposed solution.	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good Good grasp of subject matter, criticality, clear and concise arguments supporting the solution proposal.	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate Evidence of some research process with lapses in critical commentary, evidenced by an inadequate or superficial solution.	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate Work shows a substantial lack of research, through unjustified assumptions alongside a poor understanding of topics covered in class.	5 pts
Visual Communication The report demonstrates a distinctive aesthetic/identity consistent with the	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent Excellent report, communication has	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good The Capstone project process has been	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate Communication has been somewhat unclear	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate Visual communication has been ineffective,	5 pts

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graphic design/branding of your proposed solution. - Written report is clear, following good layout and composition practices.	been effective, informative, and engaging using adequate layout and imagery.	clearly communicated in the report with the use of adequate imagery.	due to lack of adequate imagery, confusing narrative and/or confusing report structure.	due to lack of visual material to support the design process, or/and unclear/incomplete narrative for the report.	
Innovation The project presents an innovative solution that does not exist/has not been explored in the local context (Aotearoa).	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent The solution is desirable, technologically feasible, and economically viable. Plus, it has a wow factor!	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good The solution is desirable, technologically feasible, and economically viable.	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate The solution is adequate but needs further iterations to become more desirable and/or technologically feasible and/or economically viable.	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate The solution is not novel, and/or needs further iterations to become more desirable and/or technologically feasible and/or economically viable.	5 pts
Impact The project creates a positive social/cultural/environmental and/or economic impact for Aotearoa. The impacts of the project have been explored and effectively communicated in the visual project report, using adequate diagrams.	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent The solution creates a great positive impact, clearly communicated in the report through adequate impact models.	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good The solution creates a positive impact, as communicated in the report through adequate impact models.	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate Impact analysis needs more depth and/or was not clearly communicated through adequate models.	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate Impact analysis should have been deeper and more critical. Opportunities have been missed and/or were not clearly communicated through adequate models.	5 pts
Prototyping Process The report effectively communicates the iterative prototyping process,	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate	5 pts

Criteria	Ratings				Pts
demonstrating how ideas evolved in response to feedback over the semester. Photos of tests, early diagrams and experiments are included.	Excellent understanding of subject matter, contextual issues and well synthesised arguments supporting the proposed solution.	Good grasp of subject matter, criticality, clear and concise arguments supporting the solution proposal.	Evidence of some research process with lapses in critical commentary, evidenced by an inadequate or superficial solution.	Work shows a substantial lack of research, through unjustified assumptions alongside a poor understanding of topics covered in class.	
Cultural Positionality and Treaty Partnership Critical choices and positionality reflections in relation to Treaty Partnership centred on: Whaanau – relationships and collective belonging Kaitiakitanga – protection and care Mahi tahi – collaboration and partnership Hanga – creation through purposeful action Huri hanga – diversity, plurality and transformation	5 to >4.0 Pts Excellent Demonstrates deep critical reflection on cultural positionality and thoughtfully integrates Te Tiriti partnership principles into the design process and proposed solution.	4 to >3.25 Pts Good to very good Demonstrates clear understanding of cultural positionality and Te Tiriti partnership, with meaningful application of relevant principles to the design process and solution.	3.25 to >2.5 Pts Adequate Demonstrates some awareness of cultural positionality and Treaty partnership, but reflection or application is limited, descriptive, or inconsistent.	2.5 to >0 Pts Inadequate Demonstrates little or no understanding of cultural positionality or Te Tiriti partnership. Reflection is absent, superficial, or unsupported, with minimal consideration of relevant principles.	5 pts
Total points: 40					